

INSIDE THE INDUSTRY

\$2,165.

That is what your seller loses when you sit on both sides of the deal. New data on 15 million sales.

D.J. Paris

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ZILLOW LOOKED AT 15 MILLION HOME SALES.

Dual agency cost sellers money in every single year they measured. Not a one-off. A pattern.

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THE STUDY, IN ONE LINE.

Zillow released it on May 14, 2026. It analyzed more than 15 million transactions from 2023 to 2025.

\$2,165 PER HOME.

That is the average a seller lost in a dual-agency deal, compared with a seller who had separate representation on the other side.

IT SHOWED UP EVERY YEAR.

The price penalty was not a fluke in one hot market. It appeared in every year Zillow analyzed.

THAT MONEY CAME FROM YOUR SELLER'S CHECK.

When one agent collects both sides,
the seller absorbs the price effect.

The conflict is structural, not
personal.

THREE WAYS TO HANDLE IT:

- 1** Refer the buyer out. You keep the listing side, your seller keeps the full price.
- 2** Staying dual? Disclose it in writing, and cite this study, above your state minimum.
- 3** If you stay on both sides, credit money back to the seller. Around \$2,000 is a fair floor.

THE TAKEAWAY

**BEFORE YOUR NEXT
DOUBLE-ENDED
DEAL, PICK ONE OF
THESE THREE AND
PUT IT IN WRITING.**

\$2,165 is what it costs your seller to skip that step.

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